

C Programming

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STRUCTURES

A Structure is a data type suitable for grouping data elements together. Lets create a new data structure suitable for storing the date. The elements or fields which make up the structure use the four [basic data types](#). As the storage requirements for a structure cannot be known by the compiler, a definition for the structure is first required. This allows the compiler to determine the storage allocation needed, and also identifies the various sub-fields of the structure.

```
struct    date {  
    int    month;  
    int    day;  
    int    year;  
};
```

This declares a NEW data type called *date*. This date structure consists of three basic data elements, all of type [integer](#). **This is a definition to the compiler.** It does not create any storage space and cannot be used as a variable. In essence, its a new data type keyword, like *int* and *char*, and can now be used to create variables. Other data structures may be defined as consisting of the same composition as the *date* structure,

```
struct    date    todays_date;
```

defines a variable called *todays_date* to be of the same data type as that of the newly defined data type struct *date*.

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